

Is your website leaking customer data?

Most small business websites in South Africa fail at least one of these 4 security checks. The scary part: most owners only find out after a customer complains — or after a fine.

POPIA — WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOU

Since July 2021, South Africa's **Protection of Personal Information Act** requires every business that holds customer details (names, numbers, bookings, orders) to keep them **safe**. If a customer's info leaks from your website, the Information Regulator can fine you up to **R10 million** — and you're the one liable, not your web developer.

1 Can you tell who's who?

CHECK 1

Authentication. If your site takes bookings, orders or payments, it must **verify** that a person is who they say they are before letting them in — a password, an OTP, a Google/Apple login. A site where "anyone can be anyone" cannot protect anyone.

? **Ask:** Can a visitor access customer-only areas without logging in?

2 Can a robot flood you?

CHECK 2

Rate limiting. A bot can fire your contact form or booking page **500 times a minute** — fake bookings, spam messages, even crashing your site. Secure sites limit how many requests one visitor can make in a short time.

? **Ask:** Could someone (or something) spam your form 100 times in one minute?

3 Can one customer see another's data?

CHECK 3

Row-level security. This is the big one — and it has a **5-second test** you can run yourself:

THE 5-SECOND PRIVACY TEST

1. Log into your site as one customer (e.g. **JOHN**). Copy the web address (URL) of John's page.
2. Log out. Log in as a different customer (e.g. **NANCY**).
3. Paste John's URL into the address bar.

🚨 If you can still see John's details while logged in as Nancy — **YOUR SITE IS LEAKING CUSTOMER DATA**. Every customer on your site can see every other customer's info.

4 Does the site trust strangers?

CHECK 4

Server-side validation. Everything a visitor types into your site (name, phone, email) must be **double-checked by the server** before it's saved. A form that trusts whatever comes in is the most common way hackers get into a database.

🔍 **Ask:** Does your site check the data it receives, or save it blindly?



Your score

Count how many checks your site passes. **4/4** = secure · **2–3/4** = at risk · **0–1/4** = exposed.

Want the full check — free?

I'll run all 4 checks on your live website and send you a plain-language report within 24 hours. No cost, no obligation, no "gotcha" upsell.

WhatsApp me: FREE CHECK →

Or reply to this message with **CHECK**.

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Checks based on OWASP Top 10 fundamentals: authentication, rate limiting, authorization (RLS), input validation.